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The situation analysis and marketing objectives undertaken by a business in the marketing process will influence the marketing strategies which they implement. Many different businesses adopt the strategies as a result of the marketing process

A situation analysis is the examination of the business and it's position in it's environment. ~~The company~~ For a marketing strategy to be efficently implemented a business owner must be able to identify the strength's, weaknesses, opportunities and threats the business faces. To undertake this a business will use a SWOT analysis which is identifying and analysing the internal influences (ster Strengths and weaknesses of a business and monitoring the threats and opportunities exposed by the external environment Major corporations such as Qantas implement

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Make a SWOT and identify their strengths as what the business is good at. In the case of Quotes this encompasses their 90% market share of the corporate sector excellent ~~se~~ service record, and their rank as one of the 10 companies as voted in 2011 Skytrax survey. As a result the business will look to promote their strengths and achievements through the marketing strategy of promotion which is informing the general public about your product. As a result the firm will use Public relations, ~~and~~ which looks to improve the relationship between the public and the business, and specifically will communicate these achievements to the general public improving the perception of the brand. By ~~analysis~~ identifying the weaknesses a business can use ~~strategies~~. The next step in the SWOT analysis is to identify the weakness of the business, such as does the business have efficient staff, what is the cash flow

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position and market share. In particular union and management disputes in Qantas is a major weakness for the firm. The business will also address the external variables of opportunities and threats which are generally outside the businesses control. This is displayed through Qantas as they are threatened by fluctuating exchange rates, and increasing competitors in the market such as Tiger airways. ~~[illegible]~~ variables also general economic conditions. As a result of the increasing competition and lower economic conditions firms will adjust their prices by change ~~[illegible]~~ to remain competitive and gain more market share. Through the strategies of price penetration ~~[illegible]~~, which is setting the price go at its lowest possible level above market costs firms will attract consumers and minimise the threat of competition and general economic conditions. This is exemplified by Qantas who price penetration of Jetstar is targeted at low income individuals

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and competing budget airlines. The firm will also review opportunities that are presented by the external environment. As a result of increasing travel to Asia, Qantas have established Jetstar pacific, introducing this new product to capitalise on demand from consumers. The SWOT analysis helps a business review their position and implement marketing strategies that are relevant.

The product lifecycle is the lifespan of the product and the different phases it encounters in it's life. They are set into four different stages that are introduction, growth, maturity and decline and will influence the marketing strategies of the business.

Introduction

This phase in the lifecycle is when a product is first brought into a market. As a result firms will look to establish a healthy product

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positioning and improve branding by establishing a reliable product to consumers. A firm will also announce themself on the market and look to increase market share through price penetration and loss leading which is selling the product below costs to help attain consumer loyalty and promotion of your product, such as Jetstar A319 tickets launched in 2004. Promotion of the business will look to increase a consumers education and awareness which can be done through heavy advertising and the promotion of increased personal selling, sales promotion and relationship marketing. Finally distribution will also be limited to your target market

Growth

~~In this cycle the business will look~~

In this stage the product is increasing in its sales and growth. As a result the firm will look to differentiate the product through

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additional intangible benefits such as customer service ~~and will~~ However during this stage a firm will increase promotion to help gain a wider audience which can be done through the communication process of word of mouth and opinion leaders. The firm will also distribute the product to a wider ~~audience~~ audience increasing the channels. This is shown by the rise of Jetstar which has ~~grown~~ announced increasing profits of 135 million

Maturity

This stage is when the product sales have levelled out and consumer trends are moving. As a result a firm will look to drop prices through generating price skimming to attract additional consumers, affecting the marketing strategies. They will also look to promote on mass at trial and repeat purchasing on retail product and brand name. However

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The brand Apple is in maturity and as a result announced a $110 million dollar advertising campaign to ~~regain~~ to ~~Apple~~ to rejuvinate their image and increase sales. ~~As a case~~ As a result of maturity ~~the~~ stage they can clearly influence the marketing strategies imposed by a business.

Decline

The decline stage is when a product is declining in sales and is near the end of it's life cycle. As a result the business may attempt to relaunch the product or sell it off as it may damage the reputation of other products in the product mix of the business, affecting the positioning of the firm. Business will also look to offload the product which will drop prices that are market based as there is a lack of demand and are usually forced into loss leading promotion ~~will~~ cease ~~as~~ and distribution

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channels will only be targeted at specific loyal and target markets. The product life cycle will influence the firms choice and adoption of market strategies.

The Once the appropriate information is collected through market research a firm will address the marketing objectives that are SMART (specific, measurable, achievable, realistic and timely) Marketing objects give marketing managers a direction and aim to achieve. The three main marketing objectives are increasing market share promotion mix and customer service. These are addressed by the firm ✓

Market share is the proportion of an industry owned by a business or a product. As a result firms such as Qantas look to own 55% of the domestic marketshare to remain ahead of it's competitors. As a result the firm will look to generate

a product which is reliable. By establishing a reliable brand a firm will increase market share as consumers will consistently return for a reliable service. By lowering prices through price penetration and loss leading, firm will also increase firm market share as consumers are attracted to low prices. This is shown through Jetstar which operates as a budget airline. Through the use of sales promotions such as, coupons and premiums (add ons) a firm will effectively attract consumers who are looking for a cheap product, increasing the market share. As intensive channel distribution strategy which aims at saturating the market with the product will result in it being widely available to the entire market resulting in increased market share as it is more available for consumers. This is exemplified by Coke who rely on intensive distribution and as a result are a leader in the industry

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Expanding the product mix is also another marketing objective that influences marketing strategies. For business to remain sustainable they need to offer a variety of products and the products are known as the product mix. This marketing objective in particular will affect the marketing strategy of the product. As a result the array of products entrance into the market is significantly helped by branding. A brand is a label, design or symbol that is associated with the business. As a result of a good brand through effective promotion it is easier to enter into the market as consumers will associate the new product with other successful products attached to that brand. This is displayed by Qantas as their successful brand has resulted in a positive perception of Qantas onto the market. The promotion

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mix will affect many different marketing strategies implemented by the firm

Customer service is an important marketing objective. This is the degree of satisfying customer wants and desires through contacting the business in pre and after sales. A business will generate excellent customer service through the concept of personal selling which is when an individual is sent to sell a product to an individual. As a result an relationship can exist generating the product successfully to the consumer resulting in sales. This is also demonstrated by Qantas through the relationships with travel agents such as Harvey world travel. As demonstrated customer service can affect the marketing strategies implemented by a business